Program Logic Models

Four programs. One promise: free, private tools that help people live their best lives.

Advocate's Compass · Beat the Craving · Goal Getter · Care About You

Prepared for Minnesota foundation partners
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Apps for Change · A Minnesota 501(c)(3) Nonprofit · appsforchange.org · sam@appsforchange.org

Our Theory of Change

Apps for Change builds free, ad-free, never-monetized mobile apps that help everyday people improve their well-being and build resilience. Our four apps each address a distinct need — self-advocacy, recovery, personal growth, and social connection — and each is run as its own program with its own population, outcomes, and measures, presented in the logic models that follow.

> **Our overarching theory of change.** IF everyday people have free, private, well-designed tools that turn good intentions into daily action — and a real voice in how those tools are built — THEN they will build the skills, habits, and confidence to advocate for themselves, sustain recovery, reach their goals, and connect with others, leading to healthier, more self-directed lives and stronger Minnesota communities.

What makes our approach different

- **Free forever, with no ads and no upsell.** As a 501(c)(3), we are structurally unable to monetize our users. There is no paywall between a person and the help they need, and crisis tools are never paywalled.
- **Privacy-first by design.** Data is stored securely in the cloud, never sold, never used for advertising, never shared with partners or funders, and deletable by the user at any time. Impact reporting uses only aggregate, de-identified totals.
- **Community-governed.** Monthly virtual town halls, written into our bylaws, let users see new features and bring their own app ideas forward. Users help set our roadmap.
- **Built with lived experience.** Focus groups with people in recovery, self-advocates, families, and everyday users shape each app before and after public launch.
- **Accessible from the start.** Apps are tested with disabled users and designed to work with screen readers and plain language.

How to read this document

Each program section opens with who we serve, the need in Minnesota, our theory of change, and the evidence behind it. A one-page logic model follows, moving from **Inputs** (what we invest) to **Activities** (what we do), **Outputs** (what we produce and count), **Outcomes** in three time frames, and **Impact** (the long-term change we contribute to). A measurement table then shows how we will know each outcome is happening. Time frames: short-term means 0–6 months of use, intermediate means 6–18 months, and long-term means three years or more.

All numeric targets are proposed 2027 targets for the public-launch year and will be reviewed by the Board after the first two quarters of real usage data.

Program Portfolio at a Glance

Program	Who it serves	Primary outcome	2027 targets
Advocate's Compass · Launching first	People with disabilities and their families navigating services	People walk into meetings prepared and voice their own priorities	1,500 downloads · 150 monthly active users
Beat the Craving	Adults in early recovery from substance use	More cravings managed without a return to use	1,500 downloads · 150 monthly active users
Goal Getter	Millennial adults pursuing life goals	Goals turned into action and achieved	1,000 downloads · 100 monthly active users
Care About You	Millennial adults seeking connection	More kindness, less loneliness	1,000 downloads · 100 monthly active users
All programs	Minnesota first; available everywhere	Healthier, more self-directed lives	5,000 downloads · 500 monthly active users

Shared Foundation

All four programs run on one organizational foundation. Funding for general operations strengthens every program at once.

Shared inputs

- **People:** Executive Director (about 40 hours per month) with director-level and frontline experience in Minnesota human services; Lead Developer (about 10 hours per month); three-member Board of Directors.
- **Technology:** Expo / React Native apps for iOS and Android; secure cloud hosting; AI provider used only on request in two apps; Google for Nonprofits.
- **Governance:** Bylaws, Conflict of Interest, Whistleblower, and Document Retention policies; a published Privacy Policy and Terms of Service.
- **Funding:** Individual donations and early operating support; a lean 2027 outreach budget.

Shared activities and outputs (2027)

Activity	Output we will count	2027 target
Monthly virtual town halls where users see new features and propose app ideas	Town halls held; average attendance; user ideas added to the roadmap	12 town halls · 10 attendees on average · 4 user ideas adopted
Focus groups with people who have lived experience	Focus groups held; participants	4 (one per app)
Community partnerships for co-design and referral	Formal partner agreements	2 (one recovery, one disability advocacy)
Accessibility testing with disabled users	Reviews completed; critical issues fixed	1 per app before public launch
Public outreach: op-eds, community events, partner channels	Pieces published; events attended	4 op-eds or articles · 6 events
Annual impact report	Report shared with Board, funders, and users	1

PROGRAM 1

Advocate's Compass

Self-advocacy learning and real-world practice · Launching first, early 2027

Who we serve

People with disabilities, their families, and support persons in Minnesota who navigate services and systems: waiver support-plan meetings, assessments, school IEP meetings, medical appointments, housing and employment conversations. The app is built for anyone who needs to speak up for themselves, and designed from the start to be usable by people with physical, sensory, and cognitive disabilities.

The need

- In 2024, **more than 74,000 Minnesotans** received services through the state's four Medicaid disability waivers: 47,244 on CADI, 25,215 on DD, 998 on BI, and 833 on CAC.[3] Every one of them has recurring planning meetings where decisions about their daily life are made.
- These meetings are high-stakes and often intimidating. People and families face complex rules, professional jargon, frequent staff turnover, and little preparation time. Self-advocacy is rarely taught directly, so many people leave meetings without having raised what matters most to them.
- Without support, people's preferences go unspoken, choices are made **for** them rather than **with** them, and follow-up promises slip through the cracks.

Theory of change

> IF people learn self-advocacy basics, prepare for meetings with plain-language scripts, and track what was promised, THEN they will walk into meetings prepared, voice their own priorities, and see more of their requests acted on — BECAUSE self-advocacy and self-determination are teachable skills that predict better life outcomes for people with disabilities.

Why we believe it will work

- Research on self-determination has found that young adults with cognitive disabilities who had higher self-determination achieved better adult outcomes, including employment and independent living.[12]
- Advocate's Compass is informed by its founder's frontline and director-level experience in Minnesota's waiver system (CADI, BI, DD, and Housing Support), where the gap between what people want and what they are able to say in a meeting is visible every day.
- AI-generated scripts run only when the user asks, are written in plain language, and are presented as a starting point the user edits — the person stays the author of their own voice.

2027 targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,500
Monthly active users	150
Self-advocacy workshops	4
Formal partner	1 disability advocacy organization

ADVOCATE'S COMPASS · LOGIC MODEL

IF people learn self-advocacy basics, prepare for meetings with plain-language scripts, and track what was promised, THEN they will walk into meetings prepared, voice their own priorities, and see more of their requests acted on — BECAUSE self-advocacy and self-determination are teachable skills that predict better life outcomes for people with disabilities.

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0–6 mo)**	**Intermediate (6–18 mo)**	**Long-term (3+ yrs)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director with Minnesota waiver-system expertise ▪ Lead Developer (Expo / React Native) ▪ Cloud hosting; AI provider for on-request scripts ▪ Disabled user testers and family advisors ▪ Disability advocacy partner (in development) ▪ Privacy Policy and governance policies	▪ Build learning modules on rights, roles, and meeting basics ▪ Build Advocate Now script generator (plain language, on request) ▪ Build meeting tracker: prep, notes, follow-ups ▪ Accessibility testing with disabled users (screen readers, cognitive accessibility) ▪ Host virtual self-advocacy workshops with partner ▪ Train partner staff and case managers to introduce the app ▪ Focus groups and monthly town halls	▪ 1,500 downloads; 150 monthly active users ▪ Learning modules completed ▪ Scripts generated ▪ Meetings prepared and tracked ▪ 4 workshops; attendee count ▪ 1 accessibility review completed before public launch ▪ 1 formal partner agreement	▪ Users understand their rights, options, and who decides what ▪ Users identify their top priority before a meeting ▪ Users feel prepared and less anxious going into meetings	▪ Users raise their top priority in meetings ▪ More requests are recorded and acted on ▪ Users track and follow up on commitments ▪ Increased self-advocacy skills and confidence	▪ People direct their own services and plans ▪ Services better match personal goals ▪ Greater independence and community inclusion ▪ Families advocate with less stress	**People with disabilities and their families shaping the decisions that shape their lives.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

ADVOCATE'S COMPASS · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source / tool	When	2027 target
Feel prepared for meetings	% of users who say they felt prepared after a tracked meeting	In-app post-meeting check-in (1–5)	After each tracked meeting	75% rate 4 or 5
Raise top priority	% of tracked meetings where the user reports raising their top priority	Meeting tracker check-in (yes/no)	After each tracked meeting	70%
Follow-through	% of logged follow-up items marked complete within 30 days	Aggregate meeting-tracker counts	Monthly	60%
Self-advocacy skills	Change in self-advocacy score	Adapted Patient Self-Advocacy Scale (opt-in)	Baseline, 3 and 12 months	60% of respondents improve
Learning	Learning modules completed per active user	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	2+ per active user
Accessibility	Accessibility issues found and fixed before launch	Accessibility review log	Pre-launch, then annually	All critical issues fixed

"Opt-in" measures are short, voluntary in-app check-ins with their own consent screen. Every other measure uses aggregate, de-identified totals. No individual entries are ever viewed, shared with funders, or used for research.

PROGRAM 2

Beat the Craving

Coping skills and accountability for recovery · Public launch 2027

Who we serve

Adults in Minnesota in early recovery from alcohol or other substance use (roughly the first two years), including people leaving treatment programs and people supported by peer recovery services. The app complements treatment and peer support; it is not a treatment program and makes no clinical claims.

The need

- An estimated **18.1% of Minnesotans age 12 and older — about 876,000 people —** had a substance use disorder in the past year (2022–2023), above the national rate of 17.2%.[1]
- Minnesota recorded **994 drug overdose deaths in 2024** (preliminary). That is a real improvement from 1,338 in 2023, but still nearly three lives lost every day.[2]
- Cravings strongly predict a return to use,[11] and they rarely happen during office hours. Structured support often thins out after discharge, leaving people alone with the hardest moments.

Theory of change

> IF people in early recovery build a personal plan of coping strategies and can reach for it in the moment a craving hits, with reminders that keep them accountable to their own goals, THEN they will manage more cravings without returning to use and build lasting recovery — BECAUSE coping skills are a cornerstone of relapse prevention, and smartphone-based recovery support has improved outcomes in controlled trials.

Why we believe it will work

- In a randomized trial, people leaving residential alcohol treatment who used A-CHESS, a smartphone recovery-support app, reported significantly fewer risky drinking days than a control group over 12 months.[10]
- Ecological momentary assessment studies show that craving measured in daily life predicts later substance use,[11] which is why Beat the Craving is built for the moment, not the weekly appointment.
- Beat the Craving is fully manual — no AI — by design. In recovery, trust is the whole value proposition, and users' entries stay private: progress cannot be shared with other people in the current design.

2027 targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,500
Monthly active users	150
Recovery-center outreach visits	4
Formal partner	1 recovery community organization

BEAT THE CRAVING · LOGIC MODEL

IF people in early recovery build a personal plan of coping strategies and can reach for it in the moment a craving hits, with reminders that keep them accountable to their own goals, THEN they will manage more cravings without returning to use and build lasting recovery — BECAUSE coping skills are a cornerstone of relapse prevention, and smartphone-based recovery support has improved outcomes in controlled trials.

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0–6 mo)**	**Intermediate (6–18 mo)**	**Long-term (3+ yrs)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director with human-services and recovery-adjacent experience ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting (no AI) ▪ People in recovery as co-designers ▪ Recovery community partner (in development) ▪ Crisis and recovery resource directory	▪ Build coping-skill library and personal coping plan ▪ Build craving log: intensity, trigger, strategy, outcome ▪ Build accountability reminders and streaks ▪ Link to 988 and Minnesota recovery resources in-app ▪ Co-design focus groups with people in recovery ▪ Outreach at recovery centers and peer-support programs ▪ Recovery-language review with partner; monthly town halls	▪ 1,500 downloads; 150 monthly active users ▪ Coping plans created ▪ Cravings logged and strategies used ▪ 4 outreach visits ▪ 1 co-design focus group ▪ 1 formal partner agreement	▪ Users identify personal triggers ▪ Users build a personalized coping plan ▪ Increased confidence in handling cravings	▪ More logged cravings managed without use ▪ Lower average craving intensity over time ▪ Growth in recovery capital (supports, skills, purpose)	▪ Sustained recovery and fewer recurrences of use ▪ Improved quality of life, health, and stability ▪ Stronger relationships, work, and housing stability	**Fewer Minnesotans lost to addiction and more people thriving in long-term recovery.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

BEAT THE CRAVING · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source / tool	When	2027 target
Coping plan in place	% of new users who build a coping plan within 14 days	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	60%
Cravings managed	% of logged cravings the user marks as managed without use	Aggregate craving-log counts	Monthly	70%
Craving intensity	Change in average self-rated craving intensity (0–10)	Aggregate craving-log ratings	Quarterly	Downward trend for returning users
Recovery capital	Change in recovery capital score	BARC-10 (opt-in)	Baseline, 3 and 12 months	60% of respondents improve
Engagement	% of users still active at 90 days	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	30%
Safety	Crisis resources reachable from every screen in two taps or fewer	Pre-launch review	Pre-launch, then each release	100%

"Opt-in" measures are short, voluntary in-app check-ins with their own consent screen. Every other measure uses aggregate, de-identified totals. No individual entries are ever viewed, shared with funders, or used for research.

PROGRAM 3

Goal Getter

Holistic goal setting, action steps, and progress · Public launch 2027

Who we serve

Millennial adults (born 1981–1996, roughly ages 31–46 in 2027) in Minnesota who want structure to move forward on goals across their whole life: finances, career, education, health, relationships, and personal growth.

The need

- Many adults know what they want to change but stall between intention and action. Without structure, goals stay vague, progress is invisible, and motivation fades.
- Stalled goals have real costs: stuck careers, financial strain and instability, and a lower sense of well-being. Most goal and productivity apps that could help are paywalled, ad-supported, or built to maximize screen time rather than real progress.
- Goal Getter offers the core tools of effective goal pursuit — specific goals, planned action steps, milestones, and visible progress — free, with no ads and no upsell.

Theory of change

> IF adults have a free, private tool that turns their goals into specific action steps and milestones with visible progress, THEN they will follow through more consistently, achieve more of what they set out to do, and experience greater well-being and economic stability — BECAUSE specific goals, if-then planning, and progress monitoring are among the best-supported drivers of goal attainment in behavioral science.

Why we believe it will work

- Decades of research show that specific, challenging goals lead to higher performance than vague intentions to "do your best."[6]
- A meta-analysis of 94 studies found that planning when, where, and how to act on a goal had a medium-to-large effect on goal attainment.[7]
- A meta-analysis of 138 studies found that monitoring goal progress promotes goal attainment, especially when progress is physically recorded.[8] Goal Getter's dashboard is built on this principle.

2027 targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,000
Monthly active users	100
Focus group	1
Formal partner	Not planned for 2027

GOAL GETTER · LOGIC MODEL

IF adults have a free, private tool that turns their goals into specific action steps and milestones with visible progress, THEN they will follow through more consistently, achieve more of what they set out to do, and experience greater well-being and economic stability — BECAUSE specific goals, if-then planning, and progress monitoring are among the best-supported drivers of goal attainment in behavioral science.

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0–6 mo)**	**Intermediate (6–18 mo)**	**Long-term (3+ yrs)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting (no AI) ▪ Millennial user testers ▪ Behavioral-science design principles	▪ Build goal wizard across life areas ▪ Build action steps, milestones, and reminders ▪ Build progress dashboard ▪ Focus group with millennial users ▪ Outreach through op-eds, community events, and partners' networks ▪ Demo new features at monthly town halls	▪ 1,000 downloads; 100 monthly active users ▪ Goals created with action steps ▪ Action steps and milestones completed ▪ 1 focus group ▪ Features added from user ideas	▪ Users set specific, measurable goals ▪ Goals broken into concrete next steps ▪ Greater clarity and motivation	▪ Users reach milestones consistently ▪ Higher self-efficacy ▪ Regular habit of reviewing progress	▪ Users achieve meaningful personal, career, and financial goals ▪ Greater well-being ▪ Greater economic stability and self-direction	**Minnesotans living purpose-driven lives with greater well-being and economic self-sufficiency.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

GOAL GETTER · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source / tool	When	2027 target
Specific goals set	% of active users with at least one goal broken into action steps	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	75%
Follow-through	% of active users completing at least one milestone within 90 days	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	50%
Self-efficacy	Change in self-efficacy score	General Self-Efficacy Scale (opt-in)	Baseline, 3 and 12 months	55% of respondents improve
Well-being	Change in well-being score	WHO-5 Well-Being Index (opt-in)	Baseline, 3 and 12 months	55% improve or hold steady
Goal achievement	% of respondents reporting they achieved a goal that matters to them	Annual opt-in check-in	12 months	50%

"Opt-in" measures are short, voluntary in-app check-ins with their own consent screen. Every other measure uses aggregate, de-identified totals. No individual entries are ever viewed, shared with funders, or used for research.

PROGRAM 4

Care About You

Kindness ideas, scheduled into real life · Public launch 2027

Who we serve

Millennial adults in Minnesota who want to be more connected to the people around them and to do more good, including people who feel isolated or lonely.

The need

- In 2023–2024, **18% of U.S. adults** said they felt lonely a lot of the previous day; among U.S. men ages 15–34, the figure was **25%**, one of the highest rates among wealthy nations.[4]
- The U.S. Surgeon General has called loneliness an epidemic, warning that lacking social connection carries a mortality risk comparable to smoking up to 15 cigarettes a day.[5]
- Most people want to be kind, but intentions get lost in busy schedules. Without a nudge and a plan, the call never gets made and the card never gets sent — and both the giver and receiver stay more isolated.

Theory of change

> IF people receive easy, personal kindness ideas and schedule them straight into their calendars, THEN they will perform more regular acts of kindness, which strengthens their relationships and reduces their own loneliness — BECAUSE doing kind acts reliably improves the giver's well-being, and scheduled plans turn good intentions into action.

Why we believe it will work

- A meta-analysis found that performing acts of kindness has a small-to-medium positive effect on the well-being of the person doing them.[9]
- Planning exactly when to act sharply increases follow-through on intentions;[7] Care About You puts each idea on the user's calendar for that reason.
- AI suggestions run only when the user taps for one, use only the details the user chooses to enter, and are never used to train AI models.

2027 targets

Measure	Target
Downloads	1,000
Monthly active users	100
Focus group	1
Formal partner	Not planned for 2027

CARE ABOUT YOU · LOGIC MODEL

IF people receive easy, personal kindness ideas and schedule them straight into their calendars, THEN they will perform more regular acts of kindness, which strengthens their relationships and reduces their own loneliness — BECAUSE doing kind acts reliably improves the giver's well-being, and scheduled plans turn good intentions into action.

RESOURCES & ACTIVITIES		RESULTS	OUTCOMES			IMPACT
Inputs	**Activities**	**Outputs**	**Short-term (0–6 mo)**	**Intermediate (6–18 mo)**	**Long-term (3+ yrs)**	**Impact**
▪ Executive Director ▪ Lead Developer ▪ Cloud hosting; AI provider for on-request ideas ▪ Millennial user testers ▪ Calendar integration (adds events, never reads them)	▪ Build AI kindness-idea generator ▪ Build one-tap calendar scheduling ▪ Build kindness log and reflection ▪ Review AI suggestions for safety and appropriateness ▪ Focus group with millennial users ▪ Seasonal community kindness campaigns; town halls	▪ 1,000 downloads; 100 monthly active users ▪ Kindness ideas generated ▪ Acts scheduled and completed ▪ 1 focus group ▪ 2 community campaigns	▪ Users plan and complete acts of kindness regularly ▪ More frequent, intentional contact with others	▪ Reduced loneliness ▪ Stronger, more reciprocal relationships ▪ Greater sense of meaning and fulfillment	▪ Sustained flourishing ▪ Kindness as a lasting habit ▪ Stronger community ties	**More connected, caring Minnesota communities where fewer people feel alone.**

Shared inputs and activities (town halls, governance, outreach) are described in the Shared Foundation section and support every program.

CARE ABOUT YOU · HOW WE WILL MEASURE SUCCESS

Outcome	Indicator	Data source / tool	When	2027 target
Kindness in action	% of scheduled acts marked complete	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	50%
Frequency	Average completed acts per active user per month	Aggregate usage counts	Monthly	4
Loneliness	Change in loneliness score among users lonely at baseline	UCLA 3-Item Loneliness Scale (opt-in)	Baseline and 3 months	50% of those respondents improve
Flourishing	Change in flourishing score	Flourishing Scale (opt-in)	Baseline and 12 months	55% of respondents improve
Engagement	% of users still active at 90 days	Aggregate usage counts	Quarterly	30%

"Opt-in" measures are short, voluntary in-app check-ins with their own consent screen. Every other measure uses aggregate, de-identified totals. No individual entries are ever viewed, shared with funders, or used for research.

Evaluation Plan

Our evaluation is designed to be rigorous enough to learn from and honest enough to report, while never compromising the privacy promise that makes our apps trustworthy. It grows in three phases as the organization grows.

Phase	What we measure	How
Phase 1 · 2027 public launch	Reach, engagement, and early outcomes for every program	Aggregate usage totals; opt-in in-app check-ins (five items or fewer, 1–5 scale) at baseline, 30 and 90 days; validated short scales at baseline, 3 and 12 months; town hall and focus group feedback
Phase 2 · 2028	Whether outcomes hold at 12 months and differ by user group	Twelve-month follow-up; review of results with partners and lived-experience advisors; first published annual impact report
Phase 3 · 2029	Stronger evidence of effectiveness for the two most mature programs	Formal pre/post evaluation with a Minnesota university or independent evaluation partner, with ethics review where required

Our data commitments

- **Opt-in only.** Outcome check-ins are voluntary, can be skipped at any time, and have their own plain-language consent screen.
- **Aggregate only.** We report totals and percentages, never individual entries, and suppress any group smaller than 10 people so no one can be identified.
- **Minimum necessary.** We collect only what a measure needs and nothing for advertising, fundraising, or AI training.
- **Aligned with our policies.** Evaluation operates within our published Privacy Policy and Document Retention Policy, and under the Board's oversight.
- **Shared back.** Results are presented at town halls so users see what their participation made possible.

Recommended measurement tools

Each tool is brief, has published evidence of reliability, and is free for nonprofit use (permissions to be confirmed before launch). They are paired with AFC's own one-to-five-item in-app check-ins on meeting readiness, craving outcomes, and goal and kindness follow-through.

Tool	Measures	Items	Used in
WHO-5 Well-Being Index	Overall well-being	5	Goal Getter
General Self-Efficacy Scale	Confidence in handling challenges	10	Goal Getter
UCLA 3-Item Loneliness Scale	Loneliness	3	Care About You
Flourishing Scale	Meaning, relationships, and purpose	8	Care About You
Brief Assessment of Recovery Capital (BARC-10)	Resources that support recovery	10	Beat the Craving
Patient Self-Advocacy Scale (adapted)	Self-advocacy and assertiveness	12	Advocate's Compass

Assumptions and External Factors

Key assumptions

- People in our target groups have smartphones and will try a free app recommended by a trusted source.
- Enough users will opt in to check-ins (we plan for about 20% of active users) to produce meaningful aggregate results.
- Partner organizations will refer participants and co-host workshops and outreach.
- AI services used on request remain affordable for a nonprofit at our scale.
- Town halls and focus groups will surface ideas that measurably improve the apps.

External factors we monitor

- **Policy change:** Medicaid and disability-waiver reforms in Minnesota may change how meetings and services work; Advocate's Compass content will be updated accordingly.
- **Digital divide:** Access to devices, data plans, and digital skills varies; partners help us reach people who are less connected.
- **App store and AI rules:** Changes to Apple, Google, or AI regulations could affect features or timelines.
- **Stigma:** Stigma around addiction and disability can deter use; privacy and respectful, person-first language help counter it.
- **Funding climate:** Our pace of development depends on growing a diverse base of individual, foundation, and corporate support.

Capacity and Growth

Apps for Change is a lean, early-stage organization: our Executive Director contributes about 40 hours per month and our Lead Developer about 10 hours per month, supported by a three-member Board. We are honest about that capacity, and it is exactly why foundation support makes an outsized difference. Each investment below directly expands what the logic models can deliver.

Investment	What it makes possible	Programs
Contract development hours	Faster, steadier releases and bug fixes after public launch	All
Paid accessibility testing	Stipends for disabled testers so lived experience is compensated, not volunteered	All; especially Advocate's Compass
Lived-experience focus group stipends	Co-design with people in recovery, self-advocates, and families	All
Evaluation tools and partner	Survey tools in 2027 and an independent evaluation partner by 2029	All
Outreach and partner workshops	Self-advocacy workshops, recovery-center outreach, partner training	Advocate's Compass, Beat the Craving

Looking ahead: community features (Phase 3, gated)

Peer connection is a powerful driver of recovery, belonging, and motivation, and it remains a long-term part of our vision. We see a future social community layer as a real opportunity to deepen outcomes across all four programs. Because shared content brings new safety responsibilities, it is deliberately gated: it will move forward only with

dedicated funding, legal review, a full Trust & Safety plan (moderation, abuse reporting, crisis protocols, and age safeguards), and formal Board approval. It is not part of the 2027 logic models above.

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